This family was quite well off and lived in Westmount (a wealthy part of Montreal). I realized that the rich Moroccan Jews, like all other middle-class or wealthier North African Jews, left in the 1950s either for North America or France, while the poor, the illiterate, and the sick were shipped to Israel to add to the Jewish population in the Promised Land. In Israel, as I said before, they were parked, often for years, in ramshackle transit camps near cities or in development towns on the periphery of the country. No wonder that in what was supposedly their Land, they stayed at the bottom of the social structure, while in North America and in France they soon mingled with the bourgeoisie and often reached some top intellectual, and even political, positions. In Israel, the situation has improved over the decades, but, as I mentioned, Begin came to power thanks to these Mizrahi battalions and Netanyahu exploited to the hilt the seething resentment of these supposedly “category B” citizens.

An Iranian drone was downed near Lake Tiberias; another one was downed over Gaza. Israel bombed Iranian or Hezbollah targets in Syria for the fourth successive time this week. Some Iranian advisors killed. Very unusual. Does Netanyahu try to provoke a large-scale Iranian response, which would represent a casus belli? In more standard actions, Israeli forces entered Nablus and killed two Palestinians suspected of aiding the gunman responsible for the Huwara double murder that ignited the mayhem. The vicious circle never stops.

Tuesday, April 4

A psychiatrist who deals with ultra-Orthodox patients in Israel told me that, as has always been the case, they are mainly interested in concrete (financial) advantages for themselves and their community, and indifferent to the other religious legislation pushed by their leaders through the Knesset.